

PROCEDURE

Clinical Alerts

Scope (Staff):	All Staff
Scope (Area):	ICAMHS

Child Safe Organisation Statement of Commitment

CAHS commits to being a child safe organisation by applying the National Principles for Child Safe Organisations. This is a commitment to a strong culture supported by robust policies and procedures to reduce the likelihood of harm to children and young people.

This document should be read in conjunction with this [disclaimer](#)

Only use this box if relevant (e.g. clinical document or available on an external website)

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Aim

To outline the requirements and process for capturing and communicating clinical alerts at ICAMHS services.

By creating a Clinical Alert (also known as Med Alert) for approval to enter onto webPAS, critical clinical information can be immediately flagged for notification to clinicians before the medical record is retrieved.

Risk

Clinical Alerts may not be consistently reviewed or actioned by clinicians. This could lead to missed or delayed responses to critical patient information, potentially impacting patient safety and quality of care.

Briefly describe what the risks are to clients/patients, staff, or the organisation if this policy is not adhered to.

Definitions

Adverse Drug Reaction (ADR): A harmful or undesirable effect associated with the exposure to a medication/drug at therapeutic or sub-therapeutic doses.

Clinical Alert (Med Alert): A diagnosis which has the potential to be of critical importance to patients' management during the first 24 hours of their admission to hospital and assumes that the patient is not always capable of communicating such information. Clinical alerts are currently divided into three categories: Anaesthetic Alerts, Drug Alerts, and Medical Conditions Alerts. Clinical Alerts are a function within the Patient Administration System (PAS) that records vital medical information that is viewable from one hospital to another.

Serious Drug Reaction: A serious adverse drug reaction is a defined reaction that may lead to a life-threatening event and has an absolute or relative contraindication to repeat administration of the drug.

Clinician: Clinicians include doctors, nurses, pharmacists and allied health professionals

MR2 Clinical Alert Form: Form used to record and communicate details of a clinical alert.

Designated Authority/Designated Gatekeeper: Once a clinical alert is raised it is to be reviewed by a designated gatekeeper from the Clinical Alerts Committee for the specific alert type. For ICAMHS the gatekeeper will be the ICAMHS Medication Safety Pharmacist.

NaCS: Notification and Clinical Summary (electronic discharge summary)

PAS: Patient Administration System (i.e. webPAS)

TGA: Therapeutic Goods Administration

Principles

- It is the responsibility of the Psychiatrist, Registrar or Senior Pharmacist to report clinical alerts in accordance with specified medical or drug-related alerts and specific detailing as per MR2 Clinical Alert form.
 - Clinicians need to reference approval from the Psychiatrist when completing an MR2 Clinical Alert Form.
- Where a clinical alert for a patient does not fit within one of the specified categories, the Medical Other (**M.Other.4**) or Drug Other (**D.Other.3**) category may be used.
- The **M.Other.4** and **D.Other.3** alerts must only be used for clinical alerts that are potentially life threatening conditions that are crucial for treating physicians to be alerted immediately on patient presentation to hospital.
- Only serious life threatening adverse drug reactions are to be documented on the PAS.

- Both the drug implicated, the date of initial reaction and the type of reaction which occurred must be specified.
- A Clinical Alert requires validation by the Community CAHS Medication Safety Pharmacist (member of the Clinical Alert Committee).
- Only Clerks and Clinical Coders can enter the information into webPAS

Steps	Allocation
1. Communicate a potential Clinical Alert to the treating medical team if the patient meets the Clinical Alert Criteria (where a Clinical Alert has not been generated by the treating team).	Nurse, Registered Medical Officer, Dietetics
2. Complete an Med Alert / Clinical Alert Notification Form (MR Alert 2) • All notifications by a Registrar require approval by the Psychiatrist.	Psychiatrist, Registrar, Senior Pharmacist
3. Send the completed Med Alert / Clinical Alert Notification Form (MR Alert 2) to the Community CAHS Medication Safety Pharmacist via email (where a clinical alert has not been generated by the Community CAHS Medication Safety Pharmacist). communitycahs.medicationsafetypharmacist@health.wa.gov.au	Psychiatrist, Registrar, Senior Pharmacist
4. Enter the clinical alert onto the eReferral platform then review and triage the Clinical Alert.	Community CAMHS Medication Safety Pharmacist
5. Enter Clinical Alert eReferral information into webPAS.	Clinical Coders
6. Affix 'Adverse Drug Reaction' alert sticker on all current medication charts for ADR's and complete the allergy section (Applicable to Specialised ICAMHS only).	All Clinicians
7. Report any suspected adverse drug reaction to the Therapeutic Goods Administration (TGA) as per the TGA instructions and document in patient records. • Provide patient with a copy of the Adverse Drug Reaction Information Brochure for Consumers	All Clinicians

Steps	Allocation
8. Handover Clinical Alert	All Clinicians

Governance

The Clinical Alert Committee is responsible for the governance of clinical alerts. Request for changes to the clinical alert categories and codes are to be raised to Clinical Alert Committee.

References and related external legislation, policies, and guidelines
1. DoH MP 0053/17 Patient Alert Policy

Related CAHS internal policies, procedures and guidelines
PCH Clinical Alerts Policy
PCH Allergy and Adverse Drug Reaction Documentation and Reporting Procedure
CAHS Medication Safety Policy
CAHS Allergy and Adverse Drug Reaction (ADR) Management Policy
CAHS Patient / Client Identification Policy

Useful resources (including related forms)
Australian Society of Clinical Immunology and Allergy (ASCIA) website. Accessed December 2023
Western Australia Department of Health: Clinical Alert Resources . Accessed December 2023
Adverse Drug Reaction Information Brochure for Consumers
MR-ALERT-2-Form
Patient-Alert-Procedure-for-Adverse-Drug-Reactions (pdf 196KB)
Patient-Alert-Procedure-for-Dietary-Food-Allergens (pdf 168KB)
Adverse-Drug-Reaction-Information-Brochure-for-Consumers (pdf 1MB)
Patient Alert Form MR ALERT 1 Form

This document can be made available in alternative formats on request.

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